

So why exactly is it that game developers go for exclusives?

The short answer – money. Well obviously it had to be that, there's no other reason for them to intentionally want to do so otherwise. Companies that make consoles – Sony, Microsoft, Nintendo, etc. (are there any others?) – often pay game developers to maintain exclusivity. They take a large amount of money for that exclusivity. But money can't possibly be the only factor here. There has to be other underlying factors that come into play as well, after all, the company is deciding to give up on a large percentage of possible business and profits. There are very few people who buy multiple consoles, in fact, not everyone can actually afford more than one console. The price of belonging to the divine hybrid master race is just too high.

When we say exclusivity here we're talking specifically about third party games and developers. Why? Well look at it this way, if Sony were to develop and publish a game, they would want to make it exclusive to their own console, i.e., the PlayStation. They don't really have any incentive to make it available to the competition. That game is a reason for people to buy their own console. Just take the Halo franchise for example, look at what it did for Microsoft. Halo has often been called the sole reason people bought the Xbox consoles. And since Bungie was, at the time, an owned subsidiary of Microsoft, it would make sense that they would opt for exclusivity. Similarly, if you didn't know yet, Naughty Dog is a subsidiary of Sony's, which is why the Uncharted franchise is exclusive to the PlayStation. And just look at how that worked out for Sony.

Now if you guys weren't aware of this, Microsoft really wanted Rise of the Tomb Raider to be an Xbox exclusive. Keep in mind however, that Rise of the Tomb Raider is a third party title, developed by Crystal Dynamics and



If you thought game devs and studios signing exclusivity deals with console platforms are idiots, then you're not too bright either. Game exclusivity contracts fully protect the game devs and studios concerns, and console platforms have to pay them large sums of money to maintain exclusivity of titles. See? No one loses, everyone wins. Except gamers! But who cares about them?



Published by Square Enix. You should be able to make some sense as to why Microsoft would want to do this. It's prequel, the Tomb Raider reboot, was a widely appreciated title, and those of you who've played it should know that it's a really good game. Microsoft's move to make Rise of the Tomb Raider an Xbox exclusive is an understandable one, they needed something to be able to compete with Uncharted. However, this didn't go down too well with the masses. The Tomb Raider franchise has been around for a long time, much before the reboot. And pretty much every title has been available on the PlayStation console. For Eidos to suddenly make Rise of the Tomb Raider

an Xbox exclusive – even if it was just for one year – one would understand why the people were all “angry mob” about it.

The fame game

Now in the case of games like Tomb Raider – which are popular enough on their own to actually help boost the sales of a console – exclusivity works mostly in favour of the said console. Square Enix is more than capable of being able fund the development of a game like Tomb Raider on it's own, and they could've easily marketed the game to both the PlayStation and the Xbox easily, especially since the prequel was hugely suc-